OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Shoalhaven Council Asked About 2025 Restructure Amid 24 Current Vacancies

Sent 24 July 2026 · To Shoalhaven City Council · Response requested by 14 August 2026

Andrew Constance
Chief Executive Officer
Shoalhaven City Council

Dear Mr Constance,

Re: Organisational Restructure and Current Recruitment Activity

I have been reviewing the latest edition of my weekly Shoalhaven City Council Vacancy Watch, based on the council's publicly available recruitment advertisements.

This week's snapshot records 24 advertised vacancies, including 11 new positions added in the past week. Of particular interest are a number of vacancies in business areas that were identified as part of the 2025 organisational restructure.

I appreciate that recruitment is a normal part of managing an organisation of approximately 1,100 staff, and that vacancies alone do not indicate organisational problems. Equally, I recognise your previously stated position that staff numbers are not, of themselves, an appropriate measure of organisational efficiency, and that service planning and financial sustainability are the more relevant considerations.

Nevertheless, the current recruitment activity raises a number of questions that I hope you may be willing to address.

Several advertised positions appear to sit within functional areas affected by the 2025 Clause 42 restructure. Are these positions replacements for roles that became vacant after the restructure, newly created positions, or roles that were intended from the outset to be filled following implementation?
Has the implementation of the restructure proceeded substantially as originally planned, or have operational requirements resulted in changes to the intended workforce design?
Where positions are being advertised in areas that were previously identified for streamlining or consolidation, does this reflect changing service demands, recruitment challenges, or lessons learned since implementation?
Does council intend to undertake a formal post-implementation review of the restructure to assess whether its objectives—including improved efficiency, simplified reporting lines and financial savings—have been achieved?
If such a review has already been completed, will it be made publicly available?
These questions are asked in the interests of helping residents understand how a significant organisational change is progressing over time. Large restructures inevitably

evolve once implemented, and there is considerable public interest in whether the anticipated benefits have been realised.

I am not suggesting that the existence of vacancies demonstrates that the restructure has failed. Rather, the recent recruitment activity appears to provide an opportunity to explain how the organisation has developed since the changes were introduced and whether the original assumptions remain valid.

Should you wish to provide a response, I would be pleased to publish it in full alongside my reporting.

How are you judged in your response? Public confidence is built by actions, not slogans. Promises of openness, accountability and restoring dignity mean little if questions go unanswered, interviews are declined, and critics are dismissed instead of engaged. The real test of leadership is simple: when scrutiny arrives, do your actions match your words?

Yours sincerely,

Steve Prothero
Editor
Eye on Shoalhaven Council
